

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Should ex-cops be able to sell cannabis?

Ald. Vasquez says no, blocks a proposed West Ridge dispensary

By Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

A business group trying to launch a North Side marijuana dispensary hoped neighbors would look favorably on their community-minded plans.

But some West Ridge residents and the area's City Council member instead looked at their resumes, saw "Chicago police officer" in their backgrounds and said "no thanks."

Ald. Andre Vasquez, 40th, came out in opposition late last month to the proposal by the Kaneh Group, which includes 10 former Chicago cops as members.

The progressive alderman said he supports opening a dispensary in the ward, but decided to halt the bid after resident push-back emphasized "a fundamental justice concern" with the retired police ownership.

"I have questions and concerns about people who were paid to arrest people who might still be in jail for selling cannabis, selling cannabis," Vasquez told the Tribune. "There's just something fundamentally unfair and unjust about it."

Vasquez does not plan to ask the City Council to make a zoning change needed by Kaneh to operate its Releaf dispensary at 2415 W. Peterson Ave., effectively blocking the business from opening.

The company's ownership team, which still hopes to launch a dispensary somewhere in Chicago, is "just like any other entrepreneurs that pursue this," partner Damone Richardson said after Vasquez's rejection.

"Our team is comprised of people who have spent decades serving the city being members of their communities," Richardson said. "They served their communities for hundreds of years between all of them, so I just feel like it's

Turn to Dispensary, Page 2



Gov. JB Pritzker exits after speaking at a news conference Tuesday on the planned deployment of federal military and Department of Homeland Security personnel to Chicago. Mayor Brandon Johnson, right, and Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton, left, also spoke at the event. JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE

Pritzker braces city for federal incursion

Trump tells reporters in Washington 'we're going in' but won't say when

By Olivia Olander and Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

In the face of continued and confusing threats that Chicago would be subjected to a federal incursion over immigration and crime, Gov. JB Pritzker on Tuesday sought to brace Chicagoans for a spike in raids from federal authorities and even potentially the National Guard in coming days.

"Let's be clear, the terror and cruelty is the point, not the safety

of anyone living here," Pritzker said at a downtown news conference, standing alongside Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson, Cook County President Toni Preckwinkle and other state leaders.

While Trump remained ambiguous — even in his most recent comments Tuesday — about a timeline or the details of a federal crackdown in Illinois, Pritzker made it clear his administration thinks Trump plans to deploy armed military personnel to Chicago's streets and direct immigration enforcement agents

JUDGE: GUARD'S MISSION IN L.A. ILLEGAL: A federal judge ruled the Trump administration "willfully" violated federal law by sending National Guard troops to Los Angeles. **Nation & World**

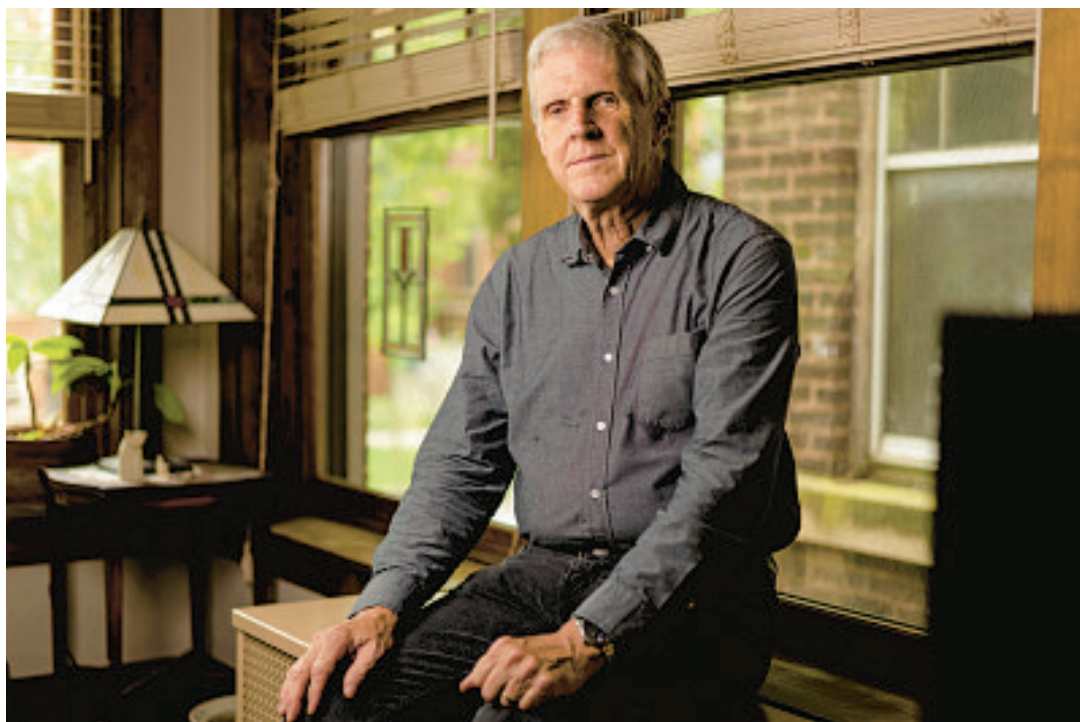
to "raid Latino communities" in the coming weeks.

The deployments would look similar to recent actions the Trump administration took in Los Angeles and Washington, D.C., Pritzker said, citing

conversations with unnamed sources and journalists, though he acknowledged the administration's plans are blanketed in rumors and speculation, and the governor blamed Washington for a lack of coordination.

The governor's announcement in Chicago came just hours after Trump told reporters in Washington that it was a matter of when — not if — he would send members of the National Guard into Chicago over the city's crime

Turn to Incursion, Page 2



Human rights attorney John Lee at his Chicago home on June 25. BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Trump-era cuts hamper work to get justice for killings in Mexico

Lawyer sought help from Chicago attorney after villagers slain

By Ray Long and Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

Fifteen years ago, Mexican attorney Alma Barraza immersed herself in a legal fight to win fair compensation for indigent villagers who lost their property when the government seized land to build a dam.

Since then, five villagers Barraza represented were killed. A man she worked with was shot dead, as was one of her body-

guards. Her brother is missing. And who committed the crimes remains a mystery.

Haunted by the lack of answers and stymied by Mexican authorities, Barraza has turned to Chicago attorney John Lee to petition an international tribunal for help in finding the truth and getting justice. But the already difficult journey for Barraza and Lee became more difficult following the Trump administration's slashing of foreign aid.

With cuts earlier this year and Washington's further retreat from international aid, reinforced by the \$9 billion rescissions package Congress approved this summer and

Trump's \$4.9 billion proposed pocket rescission last week, the federal funding that helped pay for Lee's work was decimated, and the program's future is uncertain.

The initiative, Justice Defenders, is run by the American Bar Association, which said it received up to \$3.4 million annually in federal assistance for the program from the U.S. Department of State. For years, the program has supported lawyers' work in dozens of countries, shedding light on human rights abuses and strengthening rule of law standards in criminal justice

Turn to Mexico, Page 4

Trump preparing to appeal tariff ruling to high court

President claims erosion to his trade power would inflict financial damage

By Tony Romm and Ana Swanson
The New York Times

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump is preparing to ask the Supreme Court to overturn a ruling that found many of his punishing tariffs to be illegal, claiming that any erosion in his power to wage a global trade war would inflict severe financial damage on the United States.

An administration official, who spoke on condition of anonymity, confirmed the White House's legal plans Tuesday. The work to ready an appeal follows a weekend that saw Trump blast a panel of appellate judges for their finding that he

had overstepped his authority by using a 1970s law to impose tariffs on nearly every major U.S. trading partner.

Trump has maintained that any erosion in his ability to impose levies using the International Emergency Economic Powers Act will inflict damage on the United States by robbing it of both revenue and leverage.

"Without Tariffs, and all of the TRILLIONS OF DOLLARS we have already taken in, our Country would be completely destroyed, and our military power would be instantly obliterated," Trump wrote in a social media post Sunday.

While the federal appeals court Friday ruled against the administration, it left Trump's sweeping tariffs in place until Oct. 14, allow-

Turn to Tariffs, Page 10

INSIDE

'He's been a huge force in Chicago'

Chicago tech entrepreneur Eric Lefkofsky has launched six unicorns, building a legacy far beyond Groupon. **Business**

A day in the life of two line cooks

Line cooks don't get a lot of money or respect for their craft. But what's a restaurant without them? **Food & Health**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 74 Low 49

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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